



POLICY DOCUMENT

Mandatory Reporter Policy

Staff responsibilities for recognising and reporting suspected child abuse or neglect.

The safety and well-being of every child in our care is our highest priority. All staff members are mandatory reporters and must comply with the responsibilities and procedures set out in this policy.

01

Purpose

To ensure that all staff understand their legal and ethical responsibilities as mandatory reporters, and to provide clear procedures for reporting and responding to suspected abuse or neglect.

02

Definitions

Abuse

Physical abuse, emotional abuse, sexual abuse, or exploitation.

Neglect

Failure to provide adequate food, shelter, medical care, education, or supervision.

All staff — including teachers, caregivers and administrative personnel — are mandated reporters, legally required to report any suspected abuse or neglect to the appropriate authorities without delay, based on observation, disclosure, or other information.



LEGAL REQUIREMENT

"Suspected abuse or neglect must be reported immediately."

There is no minimum threshold of certainty required — a reasonable suspicion is sufficient grounds to report.

03

Reporting Procedure

01 Immediate action

Report concerns to the Child Protection Officer or School Director immediately. If unavailable, report directly to child protective services or law enforcement.

02 Documentation

Document the date, time, nature of the concern and any action taken, promptly and confidentially.

03 Confidentiality

Reports and documentation are shared only with individuals directly involved in the investigation.

04

Response to Reports

Reports are reviewed by the Child Protection Officer or School Director, who ensures the appropriate authorities are engaged. The child's well-being is the primary concern throughout; staff offer support and reassurance without discussing investigation details with the child. Parents or guardians are notified unless doing so would compromise the investigation or the child's safety.

05



Training & Non-Retaliation

All staff receive mandatory training on recognising signs of abuse and their reporting responsibilities, at orientation and through regular refreshers. Staff who make good-faith reports are protected from retaliation, and support — including access to counselling — is available to those involved in a report or investigation.

REVISION HISTORY

VERSION	DATE	SUMMARY	AUTHOR
1.0	1 Sep 2026	Initial publication	Board of Governors

APPROVED BY

DATE

Board of Governors

Tiny Explorers Nursery & Preschool